

## II- Assay questions.

II-1) In a follow-up to Beadle and Tatum's original study, they decide to identify the genes required for synthesis of another amino acid, Leucine (L). Like Arginine, Leucine is synthesized via a series of steps. Using X-rays you create Leucine auxotrophs. You identify 20 mutants. Complementation tests reveal 4 complementation groups: 1, 2, 3, 4. They suspect that the following molecules may be precursors to Leucine (L): isopropylmalate (IP), ketoisocaproate (KC), dihydroxyvalerate (DV), ketoisovalerate (KV). Each mutant is tested for growth on minimal media (mm) + each Leucine precursor. The results are below:

| mutant | mm+ KC | mm+ IP | mm+KV | mm+ DV | mm+Leucine |
|--------|--------|--------|-------|--------|------------|
| 1      | no     | grows  | no    | no     | grows      |
| 2      | no     | no     | no    | no     | grows      |
| 3      | grows  | grows  | no    | grows  | grows      |
| 4      | grows  | grows  | no    | no     | grows      |

Draw out the pathway indicating with arrows the order of each precursor and showing where each gene functions in the pathway. (4pts)

KV-3-DV-4-KC-1-IP-2-Leu

|   | KV | DV | KC | IP | Leu |
|---|----|----|----|----|-----|
| 1 | -  | -  | -  | +  | +   |
| 2 | -  | -  | -  | -  | +   |
| 3 | -  | +  | +  | +  | +   |
| 4 | -  | -  | +  | +  | +   |

II-2) The genetic analysis shown below describe the genotypic ratios of three genes in corn: an ("Anther ear"), br ("brachytic") and f ("fine stripe"). When a plant that is heterozygous for each of these markers is test-crossed with a homozygous recessive plant, the following results are obtained:

| Test Cross              | Progeny Numbers |
|-------------------------|-----------------|
| wild type               | 98              |
| fine                    | 26              |
| brachytic               | 2               |
| brachytic, fine         | 379             |
| anther                  | 385             |
| anther, fine            | 3               |
| anther, brachytic       | 20              |
| anther, brachytic, fine | 87              |
| Total Offspring:        | 1000            |

$an^+ br f$   
 $an br^+ f^+$   
 $an^+ br^+ f^+$   
 $an br f$   
 $an^+ br^+ f$   
 $an br f^+$

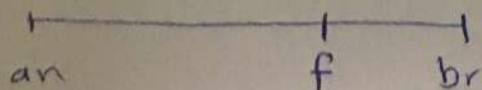
- 1) Determine the map distance between the three genes. (3 pts)
- 2) Determine the order of these genes. (1pt)

$an br^+ f$   
 $an^+ br f^+$  → middle.

$$an-br = \frac{98 + 87 + 26 + 20 + (3 \times 2) + (2 \times 2)}{1000} = 0.241 \times 100 = 24.1 \text{ m.u.}$$

$$an-f = \frac{98 + 87 + 3 + 2}{1000} = 0.19 \times 100 = 19 \text{ m.u.}$$

$$br-f = \frac{26 + 30 + 3 + 2}{1000} = 0.061 = 6.1 \text{ m.u.}$$





II-2) The sequence of a segment of mRNA, beginning with the initiation codon, is given here, along with the corresponding sequences from several mutant strains.

Normal AUG ACA CAU CGA GGG GUG GUA AAC CCU AAG...  
 Mutant 1 AUG ACA CAU CCA GGG GUG GUA AAC CCU AAG...  
 Mutant 2 AUG ACA CAU CGA GGG UGG UAA ACC CU AAG...  
 Mutant 3 AUG ACG CAU CGA GGG GUG GUA AAC CCU AAG...  
 Mutant 4 AUG ACA CAU CGA GGG GUU GGU AAA CCC UAA G...  
 Mutant 5 AUG ACA CAU UGA GGG GUG GUA AAC CCU AAG...

| First letter | Second letter |           |           |           |   |
|--------------|---------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|---|
|              | U             | C         | A         | G         |   |
| U            | UUU } Phe     | UCU } Ser | UAU } Tyr | UGU } Cys | U |
|              | UUC } Leu     | UCC } Ser | UAC } Tyr | UGC } Cys | C |
|              | UUA } Leu     | UCA } Ser | UAA Stop  | UGA Stop  | A |
|              | UUG } Leu     | UCG } Ser | UAG Stop  | UGG Trp   | G |
| C            | CUU } Leu     | CCU } Pro | CAU } His | CGU } Arg | C |
|              | CUC } Leu     | CCC } Pro | CAC } His | CGC } Arg | A |
|              | CUA } Leu     | CCA } Pro | CAA } Gln | CGA } Arg | G |
|              | CUG } Leu     | CCG } Pro | CAG } Gln | CGG } Arg | U |
| A            | AUU } Ile     | ACU } Thr | AAU } Asn | AGU } Ser | A |
|              | AUC } Ile     | ACC } Thr | AAC } Asn | AGC } Ser | C |
|              | AUA } Met     | ACA } Thr | AAA } Lys | AGA } Arg | A |
|              | AUG Met       | ACG } Thr | AAG } Lys | AGG } Arg | G |
| G            | GUU } Val     | GCU } Ala | GAU } Asp | GGU } Gly | U |
|              | GUC } Val     | GCC } Ala | GAC } Asp | GGC } Gly | C |
|              | GUA } Val     | GCA } Ala | GAA } Glu | GGA } Gly | A |
|              | GUG } Val     | GCG } Ala | GAG } Glu | GGG } Gly | G |

\*Indicate the type of mutation present in each, and translate the mutated portion of the sequence into an amino acid sequence in each case. Use the table to determine the amino acid of each codon (5pts)

Mutant 1 :- ~~Silent~~ mutation Missense mutation.  
 Mutant 2 :- ~~Non sense~~ mutation. deletion  
 Mutant 3 :- ~~Misense~~ mutation.  
 Mutant 4 :- Frameshift Mutation.  
 Mutant 5 :- Non sense Mutation.

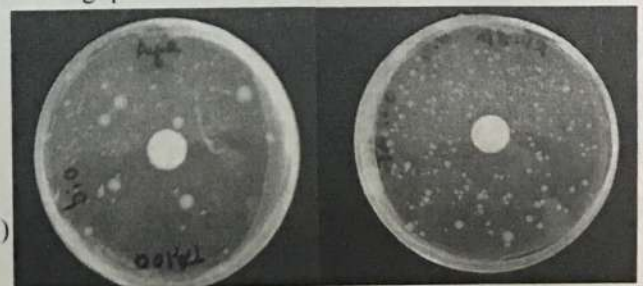
II-3) Study the results of the Ames test below and answer the following question

1) The bacteria used for this test is known as His<sup>-</sup>. What does this mean? (1pt)

auxotrophic bacteria can grow without histidine.

2) What can you conclude about the chemical tested?(1pt)

Bacteria doesn't produce histidine so it won't grow in media which lack histidine but when we add histidine to the media bacteria will grow.



Control (no chemical) Test (with chemical)

3) Why do you see some bacterial colonies grown in the control although no histidine was added? (1pt)

Bacteria doesn't have histidine but the mutation that happened make bacteria can grow without Histidine.